

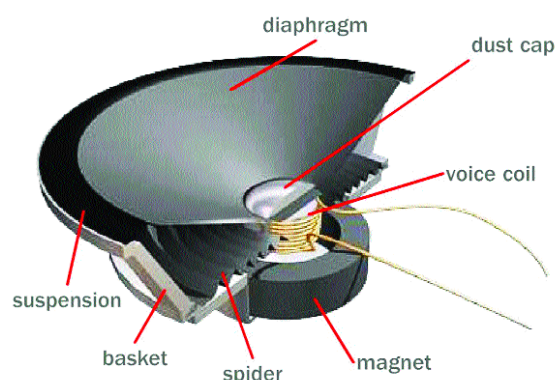
The Working of a Speaker



At the very heart of every speaker system are the drivers—electromechanical devices that convert electrical signals into sound waves.

The way a speaker works is surprisingly simple:

when a current is applied to the voice coil (suspended by a corrugated component called the spider), which consists of a wire coiled around a metallic tube that surrounds a permanent magnet, the cone of the speaker oscillates and in doing so, it compresses and expands the air immediately in front and behind it. These ripples in the air produce sound waves that we eventually hear. This entire assembly is anchored to a metallic framework called the basket.



c) Power handling test: This test was run to check the power of the speakers in reproducing low and high frequencies at high volumes. We played two MP3 files (one with low frequency sounds and the other with high frequency sounds) with the speaker volume at 100 per cent. The speakers that produced less distortion and crackling were awarded more points.

Value for money: This is a factor of the performance and features offered by the speakers as compared to its price. Therefore, the greater the performance and features and the lower the price, the higher will be the value for money rating of a speaker.

Warranty and support: Here we took into account the warranty period offered by the manufacturer, the number of authorised service centres and the number of cities in which these authorised service centres are present. The information here is as provided by the respective companies.

How they fared

The overall performance of the speakers was evaluated on the basis of four parameters, namely the features, audio performance, warranty and support and value for money. Let's go onto these parameters and see how each of these speaker systems fared.

Features

We evaluated the speakers for the presence of various features such as the number and types of connectors provided on the speaker set, the bundled accessories, thoroughness of the manual and documentation, the inclusion of an amplifier or multi-channel decoder, etc.

The largest variety of speakers is available in the 2.1 speaker cat-

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